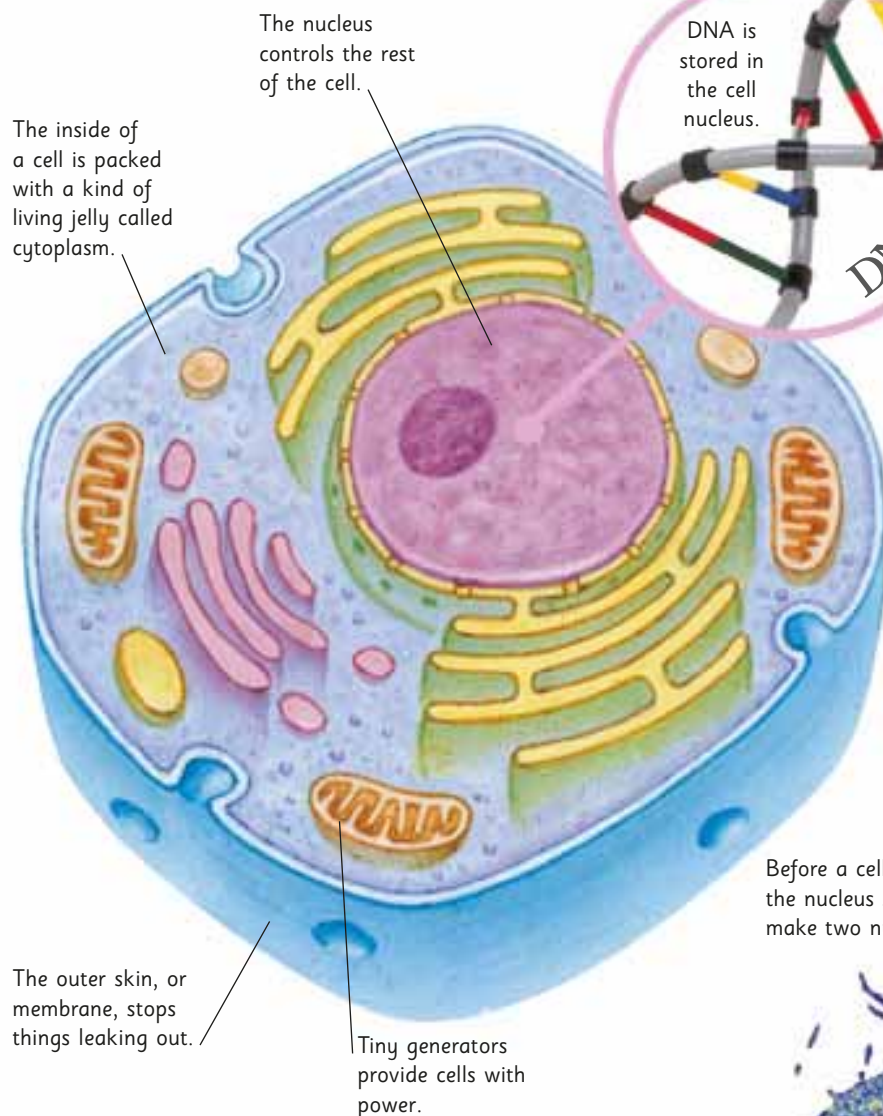


Building blocks

Every part of your body is made of tiny building blocks called cells, which fit together like bricks in a wall. Cells are so small that hundreds could fit on the point of a pin.

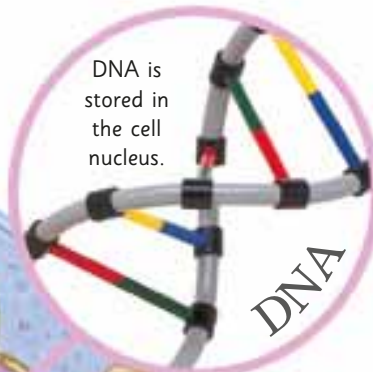


The outer skin, or membrane, stops things leaking out.

Tiny generators provide cells with power.

The nucleus controls the rest of the cell.

The inside of a cell is packed with a kind of living jelly called cytoplasm.



DNA is stored in the cell nucleus.

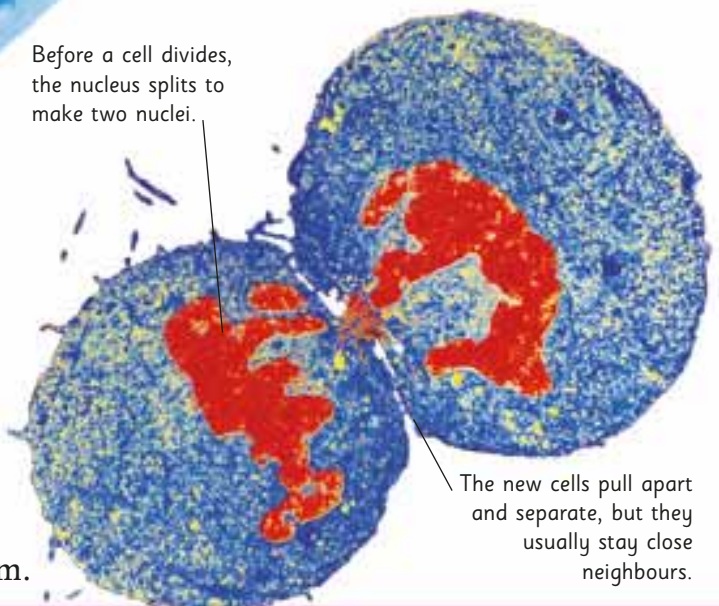
DNA

The skin on your fingertips is made of lots of small ridges.

Inside a cell

In the middle of a cell is its control centre – the nucleus. The nucleus sends instructions to the rest of the cell, telling the cell what chemicals to make.

Before a cell divides, the nucleus splits to make two nuclei.



The new cells pull apart and separate, but they usually stay close neighbours.

Making new cells

A cell makes new cells by dividing. The two new cells are half the size, but they soon grow back. Millions of your cells die every second, but millions of others divide to replace them.

How many cells are there in the human body?